

Survey Questionnaire: Utah AI Data Centers

Target Universe: Utah registered voters

Mode: Online / text-to-web survey

Estimated Length: 5–7 minutes

Q1. Issue Salience (Unaided)

What issues or concerns, if any, have you heard about regarding the construction of AI data centers in Utah?

PROGRAMMING NOTES:

- Open-ended text response
- Accept up to 400 characters
- Randomize nothing
- Soft prompt if blank: “If nothing comes to mind, please type ‘none.’”

CODING NOTES (POST-FIELD):

Code mentions into categories including:

- Water use
- Electricity demand
- Jobs/economic development
- Tax incentives
- Housing/land use
- Environmental concerns
- Noise/traffic
- Government transparency
- Other
- None/Don’t know

Q2. Issue Awareness (Aided)

How much, if anything, have you heard about proposed AI data center projects in Utah?

1. A great deal
2. A fair amount
3. Only a little
4. Nothing at all
5. Not sure

Q3. Overall Support

Overall, would you strongly favor, somewhat favor, somewhat oppose, or strongly oppose the construction of AI data centers in Utah?

1. Strongly favor
2. Somewhat favor
3. Somewhat oppose

4. Strongly oppose
5. Not sure

Q4. Concern Battery

I'm going to read several concerns people have raised about AI data centers in Utah. For each one, please say whether it concerns you a great deal, a fair amount, only a little, or not at all.

PROGRAMMING NOTES:

- Randomize item order
- Grid format acceptable

ITEMS:

- a. Water use in drought-prone areas
- b. Increased electricity demand and higher utility costs
- c. Tax incentives for large technology companies
- d. Noise and traffic near residential communities
- e. Environmental impacts on air and land
- f. Lack of transparency in local approval processes
- g. Whether promised jobs will benefit local residents

RESPONSE OPTIONS:

1. A great deal
2. A fair amount
3. Only a little
4. Not at all
5. Not sure

Q5. Economic Tradeoff

Which comes closer to your view, even if neither is perfect?

1. Utah should encourage AI data centers because they create jobs and economic growth
2. Utah should limit AI data center expansion because the environmental and infrastructure costs are too high
3. Not sure

PROGRAMMING NOTES:

- Rotate response options 1 and 2

Q6. Water Use Policy

Would you support or oppose requiring AI data centers in Utah to meet stricter water conservation standards than other industrial facilities?

1. Strongly support
2. Somewhat support
3. Somewhat oppose

4. Strongly oppose
5. Not sure

Q7. Local Control and Governance

Do you think local communities should have more say, less say, or about the same amount of say over whether AI data centers are approved in their area?

1. More say
2. Less say
3. About the same amount
4. Not sure

Q8. Perceived Economic Benefit

Who do you think will benefit most from AI data center development in Utah?

1. Local communities and workers
2. Large technology companies
3. State government
4. Construction and development firms
5. Everyone equally
6. Not sure

PROGRAMMING NOTES:

- Randomize response options 1–5
- Keep “Not sure” fixed at bottom

General Programming Instructions

- Randomize all non-demographic batteries where noted.
- Preserve response order for standard favor/oppose scales.
- Include attention check embedded after Q4:
“To help confirm you are paying attention, please select ‘Only a little’ below.”
- Terminate respondents who fail the attention check.
- Demographic questions to be appended separately using standard voter-file instrument.
- Record response time and device type for quality control.

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